FREE GUIDE · GAINCATIONS

THE BUILT TO SHOW AUDIT

Find what's holding your results back.

Five things decide whether your training shows, whether you want to lose fat or build muscle. Most people have one wrong and keep changing the other four. I'll help you find yours and fix it, the way a natural body actually changes.

LOSE FAT. BUILD MUSCLE. NATURALLY.



BEFORE YOU START

Trained for months. Mirror hasn't changed.

If you've been training for a while and what you see in the mirror hasn't changed, one of five things is off. Usually not all five. One, maybe two. Find it, fix it, and the work you're putting in starts to show.

The checks are in order of how much they matter. If two are off, fix the higher one first. Changing everything at once is the main reason I see people quit by week three.

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

1. Fill in the worksheet on the next page as you go.
2. Read the five checks. Tick the ones you honestly pass.
3. The first one you can't tick is what you fix. Follow its Tonight / This week / From now on.
4. Run the first 7 days at the back, then the Sunday check-in every week.

✎	**Your worksheet**	Your numbers, your days, your plan
1	**Calories**	Do you know your daily target?
2	**Protein**	0.8 g per pound, every day
3	**Training**	Challenging your muscles, or just moving?
4	**Sleep**	Under 6.5 hours and nothing else works
5	**Time**	Have you given it 12 straight weeks?
+	**Targets · On the plate · The plan · Cues**	The tools, right after the check that needs them
+	**Already lean · Busy week · Sunday check-in**	Building, bad weeks, and when to adjust
+	**First 7 days · 12-week tracker**	Day by day, then week by week

YOUR WORKSHEET

Fill this in. Then it's your plan.

Print it or write in the PDF. Each number comes from the page in brackets. Fill the top as you read, then come back for the audit box after the five checks.

CURRENT BODYWEIGHT

_____ lb

GOAL BODYWEIGHT (12 weeks out)

_____ lb

Losing fat: current minus 1 to 2 lb a week. Building: current plus 4 to 6 lb. Same weight, leaner also counts.

GOAL (circle one)

Lose fat · Hold · Build

DAY 1 PHOTO TAKEN ON

_____ / /

DAILY CALORIE TARGET (p. 6)

_____ kcal

DAILY PROTEIN TARGET (p. 6)

_____ g

MY THREE LIFTING DAYS (p. 9)

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

SCREENS OFF AT

_____ pm

ASLEEP BY / WAKE UP AT

_____ /

LAST CAFFEINE BY

_____ pm

STARTING LIFTS (week 1 weights)

Squat _____ Bench _____ Row _____

THE AUDIT

☐ 1 Calories ☐ 2 Protein ☐ 3 Training ☐ 4 Sleep ☐ 5 Time

The first box I can't tick is **Check ____**. That's what I'm fixing this week. Nothing else changes.

CHECK 1 OF 5

CALORIES

Do you know your daily calorie target, or do you just "eat pretty healthy"?

Healthy isn't a number. Most people I talk to who eat healthy are 300 to 500 calories over what they burn without knowing it. Fat loss needs a bit less than you burn; building needs a bit more of the right foods. Neither happens on purpose without the number.

PASS IF

You can say your daily calorie target right now, and you've tracked towards it 5 of the last 7 days.

60-SECOND TEST

Write down everything you ate yesterday, drinks included. Can't remember it, or no idea what it added up to? This is what you fix next.

THE FIX

Here's what I'd do.

Tonight: Log today honestly in a tracking app. Don't change anything yet.
This week: Track all 7 days and aim for your target from page 6. Training stays the same.
From now on: Weigh in daily. Adjust calories only when the Sunday check-in says so.

DON'T HAVE A NUMBER YET?

Bodyweight × 12 to lose fat (180 lb ≈ 2,150). × 14 to hold. × 16 to build. Full table on the next page, what it looks like as food on page 7.

☐ **I Pass Check One.** I know my calorie target and I track towards it.

CHECK 2 OF 5

PROTEIN

Are you hitting 0.8 g of protein per pound of your bodyweight?

Calories decide whether your weight moves. Protein decides what that weight is made of. Under on protein and you lose muscle with the fat, or gain mostly fat when building. It also keeps you full, so the snacking drops and the calorie target gets easier.

PASS IF

You hit bodyweight × 0.8 g on most days. At 180 lb that's about 145 g.

60-SECOND TEST

Add up yesterday's protein with the list on page 7. Under 100 g? This is what you fix next.

THE FIX

Here's what I'd do.

Tonight: Work out your number (bodyweight × 0.8) and write it on the worksheet.
This week: Build every meal around a protein first. Hit the number before anything else.
From now on: Protein stays here whether you're losing fat or building. It never comes down.

EASIEST WAY TO GET THERE

Start early. 30 to 40 g at breakfast, then 2 or 3 more meals of 35 to 50 g. Almost everyone I see fall short is trying to catch up at dinner.

☐ **I Pass Check Two.** I hit my protein number most days.

YOUR TARGETS

Calories and protein, by bodyweight.

Starting numbers for a desk-type job and 3 or 4 lifts a week. A starting point, not a verdict; the Sunday check-in corrects them in two or three weeks. Find your row, pick your column, write it on the worksheet.

BODYWEIGHT	FAT LOSS	HOLD	BUILD	PROTEIN, EVERY DAY
150 lb	1,800	2,100	2,400	120 g
165 lb	2,000	2,300	2,650	130 g
180 lb	2,150	2,500	2,900	145 g
195 lb	2,350	2,750	3,100	155 g
210 lb	2,500	2,950	3,350	170 g
225 lb	2,700	3,150	3,600	180 g
240 lb	2,900	3,350	3,850	190 g

THE FORMULA

Fat loss ≈ bodyweight × 12. Hold ≈ × 14. Build ≈ × 16. Protein = × 0.8. On your feet all day at work? Add 200 calories.

CARBS AND FAT

Hit calories and protein first. Fill the rest with food you'll keep eating: rice, potatoes, fruit, oats, eggs, olive oil. Keep fat around 0.3 g per pound.

BETWEEN TWO ROWS?

Round down if you're losing fat, up if you're building. And if the first two weeks go nowhere, the Sunday check-in on page 16 moves the number for you. Don't guess; let the scale decide.

ON THE PLATE

What 2,150 calories and 145 g of protein look like.

A real day for a 180 lb person on the fat loss column, and the protein list you'll use every day.

MEAL	FOOD	KCAL	PROTEIN
Breakfast	3 eggs + 1 cup egg whites, toast, fruit	480	42 g
Lunch	6 oz chicken, 1 cup rice, vegetables, salsa	560	52 g
Snack	1 cup Greek yogurt 0%, berries	180	20 g
Dinner	6 oz lean beef or fish, potato, vegetables, 1 tbsp olive oil	620	45 g
Evening	1 scoop whey or a piece of fruit	140	25 g
Total		**≈ 2,000**	**≈ 180 g**

Over on protein, a little under on calories: the right side to miss on. Building? Add a cup of rice at lunch and dinner.

PROTEIN, PER SERVING	G
Chicken breast, 6 oz cooked	52
Lean beef (93/7), 6 oz cooked	45
White fish or tuna, 6 oz	40
Shrimp, 6 oz	36
Egg whites, 1 cup	26
Whey, 1 scoop	25
Cottage cheese, 1 cup	25
Greek yogurt 0%, 1 cup	20
Lentils, 1 cup cooked	18
Tofu, firm, 6 oz	17
Beef jerky, 1 oz	10
Whole egg, 1	6

THE HABIT THAT MAKES THIS EASY

Pick 3 breakfasts, 3 lunches, 3 dinners you like and rotate them. Log them once, then it's one tap a day.

CHECK 3 OF 5

TRAINING

Are you challenging your muscles, or just moving?

Cardio and classes burn fewer calories than people think, and they don't build the muscle that makes a natural body look trained. That comes from lifting weights that get a little heavier over time, three or four days a week. Keep the cardio if you enjoy it; it just can't be the whole plan.

PASS IF

You lift 3 or 4 days a week, write it down, and your main lifts have gone up at least once in the last month.

60-SECOND TEST

What did you bench, squat or row three weeks ago, and this week? Don't know, or same number? This is what you fix next.

THE FIX

Here's what I'd do.

Tonight: Pick three lifting days and write them on the worksheet and in your calendar.
This week: Run the 3-day plan (pages 9 and 10). Log every set. Cardio after lifting or on off days.
From now on: Add a little weight or one rep every week. That steady increase is what changes your body, and the log is how you know it's happening.

NEW TO LIFTING?

Start lighter than you think and get the form right for two weeks. Page 10 has a cue and a swap for every exercise.

- [ ] **I Pass Check Three.** I lift, I log it, and the numbers go up.

CHECK 3 · THE PLAN

The 3-day plan.

Three sessions of about 45 minutes on non-consecutive days. Full body, so every muscle gets worked three times a week. Write the weight down every session, and next week try to beat it.

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
LIFT Day 1	walk / rest	**LIFT** Day 2	walk / rest	**LIFT** Day 3	cardio / rest	**CHECK-IN** weigh · photo

DAY	LIFTS (SETS × REPS)
Day 1	Squat or leg press 3×6-8 · Bench press 3×6-8 · Row 3×8-10 · Lateral raise 3×12 · Plank 3×45 s
Day 2	Romanian deadlift 3×6-8 · Overhead press 3×6-8 · Pull-up or pulldown 3×8-10 · Curl 3×12 · Cable crunch 3×12
Day 3	Lunge or split squat 3×8-10 · Incline press 3×8-10 · Chest-supported row 3×10-12 · Triceps pushdown 3×12 · Hanging knee raise 3×12

THE ONE RULE

Hit the top of the rep range on every set with good form? Add weight next time: 5 lb upper body, 10 lb lower. This is what gets you results faster than anything else here.

GOING TO 4 OR 5 DAYS

A 4th day repeats Day 1, a 5th repeats Day 2. Beginners, stay at 3 or 4 for the first 8 weeks. Trained a while and recover well? 5 is fine.

CARDIO, IF YOU WANT IT

Walks, an easy run or the stairmaster, 2 or 3 times a week on off days, or after the weights if you feel up for it. It just shouldn't be the reason you skip a lift.

CHECK 3 · THE EXERCISES

One cue each. One swap each.

The cue is the one thing to think about. The swap is what to do if you lack the equipment or the movement hurts.

EXERCISE	THE ONE CUE	SWAP
Squat / leg press	Sit down between your heels, chest up. Thighs at least parallel.	Goblet squat
Bench press	Shoulder blades pinched, bar to lower chest, press up and slightly back.	Dumbbell press or push-ups
Row	Pull the elbow to your back pocket, pause, lower slow. Don't swing.	Any machine or cable row
Lateral raise	Lead with the elbows, stop at shoulder height. Light and strict.	Cable or machine lateral
Romanian deadlift	Hips back, bar slides down the thighs, flat back, feel the hamstrings.	Dumbbell RDL or back extension
Overhead press	Squeeze glutes and abs, press straight up, head through at the top.	Seated dumbbell press
Pull-up / pulldown	Pull the bar to the collarbone, elbows down and back.	Assisted pull-up or band
Curl	Elbows pinned to your sides. Only the forearm moves.	Any curl variation
Lunge / split squat	Long step, back knee toward the floor, front shin vertical.	Leg press or step-ups
Incline press	Bench at 30°, dumbbells to upper chest, press up and together.	Incline push-ups or machine
Chest-supported row	Chest on the pad so you can't cheat. Squeeze the shoulder blades.	Seated cable row
Triceps pushdown	Elbows pinned, push to full lockout, control the way up.	Dips or close-grip push-ups
Plank / crunch / knee raise	Ribs down, squeeze, no arching. Quality over count.	Any of the three for another

HOW MUCH WEIGHT TO START WITH

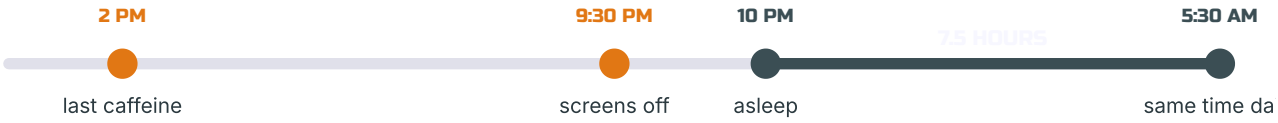
Pick a weight where the last rep is hard but you could do two more. Too easy? Go up next set. One lighter warm-up set on the first exercise of the day.

CHECK 4 OF 5

SLEEP

Are you getting under 6.5 hours?

Sleep is where your body recovers and builds, and it's the check I see busy people fail most. Under 6.5 hours, hunger hormones go the wrong way, you hold on to fat, focus drops, and training suffers because you never recovered. You can do checks 1 to 3 perfectly and still not see much change.



Example for a 5:30 wake-up. Work yours backwards from when you have to be up.

PASS IF

Asleep 7 hours or more on at least 6 nights a week. Time asleep, not time in bed.

60-SECOND TEST

Screen-off time to alarm time, minus 30 minutes. Under 7? This is what you fix next.

THE FIX

Here's what I'd do.

Tonight: Work backwards from your wake-up time. Write screens-off, asleep-by and last-caffeine times on the worksheet.
This week: Protect 7 hours on 6 nights. Keep training to 3 days so you actually recover.
From now on: Same wake-up time every day, weekends included. When sleep slips, fix it before you touch calories or training.

☐ **I Pass Check Four.** 7 hours, 6 nights, every week.

CHECK 4 · THE REAL WEEK

Sleep when life doesn't allow it.

"Go to bed earlier" isn't advice if you get home at 7. Here's what I'd actually do in the three situations I hear most.

Long days, and the evening is the only time that's yours

Give yourself a set window, 60 to 90 minutes, then screens off. The hour you give up at night comes back as a better session, less hunger and more patience the next day. If evenings are unpredictable, move your lifts to the morning or lunch so the night isn't carrying the whole plan.

Don't try to get it all back on the weekend. Two 10-hour nights don't undo five 5-hour ones.

Shift work or a rotating schedule

Anchor the wake-up time to the shift, not the clock, and keep it the same across the days you're on it. Blackout curtains and a sleep mask if you sleep in daylight. Caffeine stops 8 hours before whatever your bedtime is that week.

Don't lift on a night you slept under 5 hours. Walk instead and take the session tomorrow.

Fall asleep fine, wake at 3 and can't get back

Most often it's one of three things: last meal too small (add protein and carbs at dinner), caffeine too late, or alcohol. Fix those for a week before anything else. If you're awake 20 minutes, get up, dim light, no phone, back when you're sleepy.

Don't lie there doing math on how many hours you have left.

WHEN SLEEP IS THE CHECK YOU FAILED

Hold calories and training exactly where they are for two weeks and fix only this. Then re-run the audit. Most people find checks 1 and 2 get easier on their own.

ALREADY LEAN?

How to build muscle without getting soft.

If you're lean and the problem is that you look small, eating less won't fix it. Eat a little more than you burn, lift progressively heavier, give it time. The mistake I see most: not eating enough to grow, or eating so much you gain fat faster than muscle.

HOW MUCH TO EAT

Build column, about bodyweight × 16. You want the scale up 0.25 to 0.5% a week, roughly half a pound to a pound. Faster and you're mostly adding fat.

PROTEIN AND THE REST

Same protein, bodyweight × 0.8. Put the extra calories into carbs around training: rice, potatoes, oats, fruit.

TRAINING

Same 3-day plan, 4 days if you recover well. The weights going up every week matter more here than anywhere. Log not climbing? You're not building.

HOW LONG

12 to 16 weeks. Natural muscle gain is 1 to 2 lb a month for a beginner, less after year one. Plan for that, not for a transformation photo.

THE SUNDAY RULES FOR BUILDING

Scale up 0.25 to 0.5% and lifts climbing: change nothing. Flat two weeks: add 150 to 200. Up more than 1% a week: trim 150. Waist growing faster than shoulders: hold two weeks, check sleep and protein.

CHECK 5 OF 5

TIME

Have you given it 12 straight weeks?

If checks 1 to 4 pass, nothing is wrong. Visible change takes about 12 weeks of the same week on repeat, and the first few usually look worse before they look better. This is where I watch most people change the plan and start over.

PASS IF

12 weeks in a row where food targets and training days stayed the same, except when the Sunday check-in said to adjust.

60-SECOND TEST

How many plans, diets or apps have you started in the last year? More than one? This is what you fix next.

THE FIX

Here's what I'd do.

Tonight: Take your Day 1 photo. Same spot, same light, every Sunday from now on.
This week: Change nothing. Same targets, same training days as last week.
From now on: Tick a week off the tracker on page 17 every Sunday. Adjust only when the check-in says so.

WHAT TO EXPECT

Weeks 1 to 4: scale moves, mirror doesn't. Weeks 5 to 8: clothes fit differently. Weeks 9 to 12: other people notice. Want to quit at week 3? Compare your Day 1 photo to today's, then do the same week again.

- [ ] **I Pass Check Five.** I've given the same plan 12 weeks.

THE BUSY WEEK

What to do when the week doesn't cooperate.

The plan doesn't fail on normal days. It fails on these five. What I'd do for each, and what to stop worrying about.

Driving or on your feet all day

Pack protein before you leave: jerky, Greek yogurt, a shake, boiled eggs. Eat on your schedule, not the gas station's.

Don't skip meals and make up for it at dinner.

Back-to-back meetings

One solid protein meal before, water through it, one after. Two good meals is a fine day.

Don't graze on whatever's on the table.

Work dinner or night out

Eat lighter earlier, order a protein and a vegetable, have the drink you want. One night doesn't undo a week.

Don't track it to the gram. Estimate high, log it, move on.

Travel

Hotel gym or bodyweight circuit, 25 minutes, twice. Protein first at every meal. Walk between things.

Don't write the trip off. Maintain, then pick up where you left off.

Missed the gym

Move it to tomorrow. Two lifts in the week is two lifts. Calories and protein stay the same.

Don't cut food to make up for a missed session.

THE RULE UNDER ALL FIVE

Food on target with two lifts beats four lifts and no idea what you ate.

THE SUNDAY CHECK-IN

When to change something. When not to.

Weigh every morning after the bathroom, before food. Average the seven days. Photo Sunday morning, same spot and light. Compare this week's average to last week's and follow your column. Nothing changes on any other day.

THIS WEEK'S AVERAGE VS LAST	LOSING FAT	BUILDING
Moving the right way down 0.5 to 1% / up 0.25 to 0.5%	Change nothing. This is the goal.	Change nothing. This is the goal.
Flat two weeks in a row	Trim 150 to 200 calories. Protein and training stay.	Add 150 to 200 calories. Protein and training stay.
Moving too fast more than 1% either way	Add 150 back if lifts are dropping. You're losing muscle.	Trim 150. You're adding fat faster than muscle.
Up after a travel or dinner week	Change nothing. Water and food volume. Give it a week.	
Sleep under 6.5 h on 2+ nights	Fix sleep first. Don't touch calories until that's back.	
Fewer than 2 lifts this week	Not a data week. Hold everything and get the sessions in.	

ONE CHANGE AT A TIME

Never move calories and training in the same week. Change two things and you'll never know which one worked.

THE PHOTO BEATS THE SCALE

Scale flat but waist smaller and shoulders sharper? That's a win. Scale moving but you look the same? Check protein and sleep first.

YOUR FIRST 7 DAYS

Day by day. Then week by week.

You've found your check. This is the week. Don't add anything that isn't on here.

DAY	DO THIS	☐
Day 1	Fill in the worksheet. Day 1 photo. Log today's food without changing it. Set tonight's screens-off time.	☐
Day 2	First lift (plan Day 1). Write every weight down. Protein first at every meal.	☐
Day 3	Rest or walk. Calories and protein on target. Did you sleep 7?	☐
Day 4	Second lift (plan Day 2). Food on target. Nothing else.	☐
Day 5	Rest or walk. Prep tomorrow's protein if the day is busy.	☐
Day 6	Third lift (plan Day 3). Beat at least one number from earlier this week.	☐
Day 7	Sunday: weigh, photo, average the week. Week 1 is your baseline. Change nothing. Tick Week 1 below.	☐

12-WEEK TRACKER

Wk 1 avg ___	**Wk 2** avg ___	**Wk 3** avg ___	**Wk 4** avg ___
Wk 5 avg ___	**Wk 6** avg ___	**Wk 7** avg ___	**Wk 8** avg ___
Wk 9 avg ___	**Wk 10** avg ___	**Wk 11** avg ___	**Wk 12** compare photos

Every Sunday: write the week's average weight, tick the box, follow the check-in table. Week 12: Day 1 photo next to today's. That's the only review that matters.

WANT AN EXTRA HAND?

I'll help you get results faster.

Everything in this guide works, but running it alone for 12 weeks can be difficult. Life gets busy, meals get missed, tracking gets messy, the scale does something confusing, and you're not sure yet whether to adjust or hold. That's the learning curve, and it's where most people lose their first three months.

Coaching gets you over it faster. With me:

- I set your targets, and I adjust them as your body changes.
- I show you what to eat that fits your actual week, not a meal plan you'll quit by Thursday.
- I track your training and make the Sunday call for you: change this, keep that.
- Something comes up midweek, or you have a question about anything, you message me and get an answer.

I keep spots limited so every client gets the attention the results require. Let's work together.

Start coaching **Book a free 15-min call**